

2018-Ph-H1-Q15

Section: Particles and Waves

Topic: Nuclear Reactions

Which statement describes beta decay?

- A. A proton becomes a neutron
- B. A neutron becomes a proton
- C. An electron joins a nucleus
- D. A helium nucleus is emitted

Solution:

In **beta decay**, a neutron turns into a proton and emits an electron (beta particle).

Answer: B

Revision Tip:

Beta decay = neutron $\rightarrow$ proton + electron

Alpha decay = helium nucleus emitted

Learn all four decay types and what's emitted.